Mile Marker #6: My Academic Plan

Not a final decision. A starting point for the conversation with your Success Coach.

You don't have to have everything figured out. Four things are enough to walk into an advising appointment and have a real conversation: what your interest results told you, one direction worth exploring, what you need to ask, and what your next semester could realistically look like.

For in-person classes. Fill in this handout by hand, then upload a photo or scan to the Mile Marker #6 assignment in Blackboard. You can also type in the boxes and save it as a PDF. **Before you start,** take the Career Coach assessment, and sketch your next semester in the Academic Planner.

NAME _____ **DATE** _____

QUESTION 1

Your Interest Results

*Look at your Career Coach results (or the O*NET Interest Profiler).*

A strong answer *Names your top interest types, says honestly whether they fit you, and connects your results to at least one career direction.*

1. Name your top two or three interest types, and say whether they feel accurate.

2. Name one career match that surprised you, confirmed something, or made you curious.

QUESTION 2

One Direction Worth Exploring

Based on your results and your own instincts, choose one program or pathway at OCTC to learn more about.

A strong answer *Names one real OCTC program, explains why that credential type fits your goals and how it differs from the other options, and is honest about what you still need to find out.*

1. Name one OCTC program you want to know more about, and why.

2. Choose the credential that fits your goals right now. *(choose one)*

☐ Certificate ☐ Diploma ☐ AAS (career degree) ☐ AA or AS (transfer degree)

☐ Not sure yet

3. Explain why that credential fits, and how it differs from the other options.

4. Name one thing you still need to find out about it.

QUESTION 3

Your Questions for Your Success Coach

Write five specific questions to bring to your advising appointment, most important first. Make them about your situation, your program interest, and your timeline. Include at least one about transfer, financial aid, or the order of your courses.

A strong answer *Lists five real, specific questions in priority order, with at least one about transfer, financial aid, or course order.*

1. Your most important question

2. Your second question

3. Your third question

4. Your fourth question

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5. Your fifth question

QUESTION 4

Your Next Semester

Sketch a realistic course load. It's a draft, and your Success Coach will help you finalize it.

A strong answer *Names specific courses and an approximate credit load, explains why it's realistic for your life, and mentions one thing about prerequisites or course order.*

1. List the courses you're thinking about, and about how many credit hours that would be.

2. Explain why that load is realistic with your work, family, and other commitments.

3. Name one thing you learned about prerequisites or course order.